

Jesse Clark

+1 (408) 888-8883 jesse@modusponens.org [LinkedIn.com/in/jessejohnclark](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jessejohnclark)
Permanently eligible to work in Australia and in the United States.

Summary

Product-oriented, research-minded computer scientist. Obsessed with cool technology like single-molecule sensors, social robots, and spaceflight.

Employment

Geneus Technologies, Mountain View, California

May 2023 – May 2024

Principal Algorithm Engineer

Established dry-lab operations at a new office for a Chinese biotechnology company (深圳今是科技有限公司).

- Hired a data science team, managed local projects, and reported to head office.
- Developed primary analysis algorithms for a nanopore DNA sequencing instrument.
- Designed statistical models to infer hidden variables from raw time-series sensor data, and calculate Phred quality scores.
- Systematically compared algorithms for signal processing, base-calling, and sequence alignment. Selected high-accuracy algorithms to produce neural network training data, and high-performance algorithms for use in production.

Roche Molecular Diagnostics, Santa Clara, California

December 2019 – May 2023

Principal Software Engineer

Developed software for [nanopore sequencing](#) instruments. Worked with all aspects of primary DNA analysis, including molecule detection, level-calling, base-calling, quality metrics, and neural network training.

Implemented data pipelines with [AirFlow](#) and [Jenkins](#).

Coordinated data compatibility between wet-lab experimentalists, GPU-accelerated signal processing, machine learning model training, and statistical simulations. Created validation tools to enforce data compatibility agreements and prevent unnecessary processing or troubleshooting.

University of Technology, Sydney, Ultimo, New South Wales

November 2014 – December 2019

Senior Software Engineer

Responsible for software operations for a [social robotics research lab](#).

- We won first place in the global [RoboCup@Home](#) competition. I was responsible for software system reliability and natural language processing.
- Developed software for social robotics experiments, and published several [open-source software packages](#).
- Presented research results at conferences.
- Mentored entrepreneurship students in rapid application development techniques.

Developed curriculum and delivered university lectures and masterclasses on these subjects:

- iOS Application Development (including automated evaluation of coursework with CI-driven unit tests)
- Digital Forensics
- SQL databases used for NASA mission planning
- Neural networks for human-robot interaction (object, face, and voice perception)
- Software Engineering (source control, continuous integration, Python and Debian package management, Docker containers, web components)

Sydney Programming School, Mosman, New South Wales

April 2015 – December 2019

Head of Teaching

Delivered programming lessons at an after-school program, as it grew from zero to over 1,000 students aged 8–13. This program has been well received and students can demonstrate new computational thinking skills.

Developed curriculum for:

- [Animation and Game Design](#) with Scratch and Snap
- [Computer Graphics](#) with JavaScript
- [Cryptography and Blockchain](#) with Python
- [Robotics](#) with Arduino and Lego

Lesson plans are available for licensing.

Destination Software

2013 – 2014

Head of Product Development

Developed a high-availability e-commerce web server for the travel and hospitality industry. Implemented automated deployment and zero-downtime updates of Node.js and [Riak](#) servers. Supported web-accessible map/reduce queries of combined domain data and analytics data. Trained new developers in MVC and Agile methodologies.

GoBoldly, San Francisco, California

2013

Full-Stack Developer

Implemented a novel isomorphic web application engine that works even in javascript-disabled environments, and progressively enhances based on available functionality. Implemented an iOS frontend and [Parse.com](#) backend for a geo-social networking app.

Scanadu, Mountain View, California

2012

iOS Developer

Developed an iPhone application to capture images of molecular test strips and interpret the results in an augmented reality display.

Soundwave

2011

Developed a prototype iPad music education app to present to investors.

Modus Ponens, LLC, Palo Alto, California

2011 – 2014

Self-owned Consulting Business

Founded a new business to develop web and mobile applications for Silicon Valley startups. Applied many cutting-edge technologies to deliver maximum value to clients. Led teams of local and remote designers and developers. Had contact with prominent venture capitalists.

NASA Ames Research Center, Moffett Field, California

July 2007 – April 2011

Computer Scientist

Worked with the [Human-Computer Interaction Research Group](#) to develop innovative and highly dependable mission evaluation systems for the Space Shuttle, International Space Station, and Constellation programs. These systems were designed to enhance operator and astronaut safety and productivity. Acquired domain expertise and managed data-entry efforts to import legacy records. Implemented fulltext search, advanced relational search functionality, custom report formatting, and usability features for search interfaces. Deployed a continuous integration daemon. Established an automated testing framework.

NASA Goddard Space Flight Center, Greenbelt, Maryland

June 2004 – June 2007

Computer Engineer

Developed robotics and graphics software to simulate contact dynamics for [Hubble Space Telescope Servicing Mission 4](#). Used a [FANUC](#) industrial robot and a computer running a physics simulation to mimic the behavior of a [Canadarm](#), which is too lightweight to operate normally in Earth gravity. Used capacitive sensors to guide robotic orientation, and summarized those sensors in a congressional [design review](#).

Recovered legacy climate data from the [Nimbus](#) and [TIROS](#) projects. Wrote Perl scripts to correct for degradation and translate to modern formats. Visualized results in [Mathematica](#).

Wheels of Zeus, Los Gatos, California

2003

Wrote PIC assembly code and laid out a printed circuitboard for a Segway key duplicator.

Institute for Computer Assisted Orthopaedic Surgery, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

May 2002 – July 2002

Intern

Designed and developed a graphical user interface for hospital patient database management and integration with in-house tools. Developed a C program to align x-rays with CT scans to track implant drift over time. This used a 6-dimensional BFGS search based on 3-d models and DICOM data. Modified control hardware for use with augmented reality in the operating room.

Refract Media, Los Gatos, California

1997 – 2000

Configured and maintained Linux servers for a web hosting company during the dot-com boom.

Board Membership

Johnson and Louise H. Clark Charitable Foundation, Saratoga, California

April 2023 – Present

Treasurer

Managing financial accounts for a family-run charitable foundation.

Open-Source Software Publications

Published explorable explanations and examples of best practices in several frameworks, for use in instructional materials. Published various small packages for file format conversion, terminal graphics, and text markup.

- [Zodiac](#) — Isomorphic web application engine using Backbone and Riak
- [Dwarf Fortress Tileset Previewer](#)
- [REXPaint Web Viewer](#)
- [Factorio Server Control Panel](#)
- [Series Odds Calculator](#)
- [Procrastinator's Clock](#)
- [Text Perpendicularizer](#)
- [Incremental](#) — Tamper-resistant polynomial timer based on closed-form maths
- [Dungeon Diagrams](#) — Daily puzzle game
- [Bitburner](#) — Developed UX-driven features to explain and preview game mechanics. Reworked balance of the venture-capital minigame. Published [detailed analysis](#) of optimization puzzles.
- [Original solutions](#) to [Advent of Code](#) programming puzzles, with visualizations and demonstrations of various programming paradigms

Worked with the open-source community to discover areas for improvement in popular software packages, implement those improvements and automated tests to verify them, and publish the results. Notable contributions:

- [ROS](#) — Preeminent Robot Operating System
- [Docker](#) — Application container engine
- [Metalsmith](#) — Static website generator (used to generate this HTML/PDF document)
- [Gulp.js](#) — Streaming build system
- [Handlebars.js](#) — Declarative template engine
- [Dust.js](#) — Asynchronous template engine
- [Rivets.js](#) — Frontend data binding library
- [Bugzilla](#) — Widely-used bug tracking system
- [Audacity](#) — Cross-platform audio software
- [Remi](#) — Remote interface for Python applications

Academic Publications

1. Jesse Clark; Lenore Blum (2004): **Reversible Cellular Automata on Infinite Configurations**
Presented at *Wolfram New Kind of Science 2004*.
2. Jesse Clark; Mary-Anne Williams: **Building a Content Management System with Static Site Generation Technology**

In preparation for submission to the *ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management*.

3. Xun Wang; Jesse Clark; Peter Gärdenfors; Mary-Anne Williams: **Human Interpretation of Robot Pointing**
In preparation for submission to the *Human-Robot Interaction Conference*.
4. Tonkin, Meg; Vitale, J.; Ojha, Suman; Clark, Jesse; Pfeiffer, Sammy; Judge, William; Wang, Xun; Williams, Mary (2017): **Embodiment, Privacy and Social Robots: May I Remember You?**
Presented at International Conference on Social Robotics, Tsukuba, Japan
5. Herse, S.; Vitale, J.; Ebrahimian, D.; Tonkin, M.; Ojha, S.; Sidra, S.; Johnston, B.; Phillips, S.; Gudi, S. L. K. C.; Clark, J., *et al.* (2018): **Bon Appetit! Robot Persuasion for Food Recommendation**
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction
6. Vitale J, Tonkin M, Herse S, Ojha S, Clark J, Williams M, Wang X, Judge W (2018): **Be More Transparent and Users Will Like You: A Robot Privacy and User Experience Design Experiment**
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction
7. Sammy Pfeiffer, Daniel Ebrahimian, Sarita Herse, Tran Nhut Le, Suwen Leong, Bethany Lu, Katie Powell, Syed Ali Raza, Tian Sang, Ishan Sawant, Meg Tonkin, Christine Vinaviles, The Duc Vu, Qijun Yang, Richard Billingsley, Jesse Clark, Benjamin Johnston, Srinivas Madhisetty, Neil McLaren, Pavlos Peppas, Jonathan Vitale & Mary-Anne Williams (2019): **UTS Unleashed! RoboCup@Home SSPL Champions 2019**
RoboCup 2019: Robot World Cup XXIII

Education

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania

May 2004

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematical Sciences

(4-year degree with research component — equivalent to an Honours degree)

Coursework in systems programming, artificial intelligence, machine learning, cryptography, computational linguistics, bioinformatics. Systems programming experience, including implementation of a TCP/IP network stack, context-switching kernel, memory manager. Major research project developed a genetic algorithm to solve constrained optimization problems in Mathematica.